



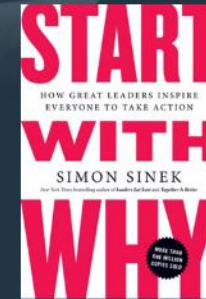
PURPOSE

Having a Clear Life Direction

Defining Your Purpose and Direction



Purpose is a personal guiding principle that gives your life direction, meaning, and motivation. It's not just a goal or ambition but a fundamental understanding of what drives you at your core. Purpose can be tied to your values, passions, and the impact you want to have on the world.



"Very few people or companies can clearly articulate WHY they do WHAT they do. By WHY I mean your purpose, cause or belief - WHY does your company exist? WHY do you get out of bed every morning?"

Simon Sinek from 'Start with Why'

Why is Purpose so Important When it Comes to Resilience?



Having a well-defined purpose is like having a North Star—it provides direction, meaning, and motivation, especially in times of adversity.



By anchoring yourself to a purpose, you build resilience that enables you to navigate life's challenges with greater strength and clarity.



Motivation in Adversity

Purpose provides a reason to keep going, even when things get tough, fuelling perseverance and determination, helping you push through challenges.



Clarity in Decision-Making

When you have a clear purpose, it acts as a compass that guides your decisions, helping you focus on what truly matters even in stressful situations.



Emotional Strength

A strong sense of purpose can bolster emotional well-being, reducing feelings of helplessness and foster a positive outlook, even in the face of setbacks.



Sense of Belonging

Purpose often connects you to something larger than yourself, whether it's a community, a cause, or a mission, which can provide a sense of belonging and significance.

Defining Your Purpose - Best Practice



Reflect on Your Values and Passions

Identify what matters to you most, think of your core values and activities that make you feel alive. Your purpose should align with these intrinsic motivations.



Consider Your Strengths and Skills

Reflect on your talents and how they can contribute meaningfully. Purpose often lies where your passions, skills and the world's needs intersect.



Look Beyond Yourself

Purpose often involves contributing to the wellbeing of others and the world. Consider how your actions could positively impact those around you.



Write It Down

Draft a purpose statement encapsulating your main motivations and goals. Revisit and refine it over time to gain clarity.



Seek Feedback

Talk to trusted friends, family, or mentors about your purpose. Sometimes others can see strengths and passions in you that you may not fully recognize.



Align Your Actions with Your Purpose

Regularly assess whether your daily actions and decisions are aligned with your purpose. This alignment creates a sense of coherence in life, which is essential for sustained resilience.



Stay Open to Evolution

Purpose is not static; it can evolve as you grow and as your life circumstances change. Be open to re-evaluating and redefining your purpose as needed.

Best Practice

Defining Your 'Ikigai' or Purpose

- Think about the things that you love.
- Identify your strengths – the things you are good at.
- Work out what you can be paid for.
- Understand what the world needs and where you can make a difference.
- If you can balance all of these, you will have found your Ikigai.

It's not easy, so look for the balance in and out of work to find your Ikigai.



Having a Clear Life Direction



EXERCISE 1

Defining Your Purpose

This step-by-step exercise is designed to help you explore your values, passions, strengths, and aspirations to articulate a clear and meaningful purpose. Set aside some quiet time, grab a journal or a notebook, and follow these steps:



STEP 1

Reflect on Your Core Values

- Write down 5-10 values that are most important to you.
- Rank your values in order of importance and meaning to you.
- Reflect on how well your actions align with your core values.



STEP 2

Identify Your Passions & Interests

- List activities or topics that energize and bring you joy.
- Explore why each passion matters and what you love about it.
- Look for patterns or connections between your different passions.



STEP 3

Assess Your Strengths & Skills

- Write down both hard and soft skills you excel at.
- Reflect on how your strengths have helped you and others.
- Identify ways your strengths can create a positive impact.



STEP 4

Visualize Your Ideal Future

- Picture yourself living your ideal life and what it looks like.
- Describe your vision of the future in as much detail as possible.
- Highlight the elements of your vision that inspire you most.



STEP 5

Craft Your Purpose Statement

- Combine your values, passions, strengths, and vision into one idea.
- Write a concise purpose statement that captures what drives you:
 - *"My purpose is to [use your strengths] to [what impact you want to make] in order to [reason/why it matters]."*
 - *Example: "My purpose is to use my creativity and empathy to inspire and support others in overcoming challenges, helping them realize their potential and live fulfilling lives."*
- Refine your statement until it feels authentic and meaningful.



STEP 6

Align Your Actions with Your Purpose

- Identify specific, actionable goals that align with your purpose. These could be short-term or long-term goals, both personal and professional.
- Develop daily habits that help reinforce and support your purpose.
- Regularly review your purpose statement, are you living in alignment with it? What adjustments can you make to stay on track?



STEP 7

Stay Open to Evolution

- Revisit periodically: Your purpose evolves with growth and life changes.
- Embrace shifts as life is dynamic, and your purpose adapts with new insights.

Having a Clear Life Direction

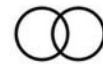


EXERCISE 2

Using the Ikigai Model for Self-Reflection

Ikigai is a Japanese concept that means "reason for being." The Ikigai model is a powerful tool for self-reflection that helps you find a sense of purpose and direction in life by exploring four key areas:

1. What You Love (Passion)
2. What You Are Good At (Strengths)
3. What the World Needs (Impact)
4. What You Can Be Paid For (Profession)



STEP 1

Reflect on Each Quadrant

- **What You Love:**
List activities, hobbies, or causes you are passionate about.
- **What You Are Good At:**
Identify your strengths, skills, and talents, both natural and learned.
- **What the World Needs:**
Consider the needs of the world or your local community.
- **What You Can Be Paid For:**
Reflect on where your skills and passions align with paid opportunities.



STEP 2

Explore the Intersections

- **Passion (Love + Good At):**
Find activities that combine what you love with what you are good at.
- **Mission (Love + Needs):**
Explore causes where your passions meet the world's needs.
- **Vocation (Needs + Paid For):**
Identify careers where you can be paid for meeting a need.
- **Profession (Good At + Paid For):**
Look for roles that use your strengths and provide financial reward.



STEP 3

Find Your Ikigai

- **Centre Point (Ikigai):**
Reflect on where love, skills, needs, and payment align to find Ikigai.



STEP 4

Create an Action Plan

- **Set Goals:**
Set actionable goals to move closer to your Ikigai state.
- **Align Daily Actions:**
Establish daily habits that gradually bring your life into alignment.